

LAW & ORDER

VARIABLES: Actual strength of civil policemen/lakh population, percentage of pending cases (under Indian Penal Code), total cognizable crimes/incidence of murder, kidnapping, rape and molestation

BIG STATES

RANK 2007		2007	2006	2005	2004	2003
1	KERALA	4.15	1	1	1	1
2	TAMIL NADU	2.18	2	2	2	2
3	KARNATAKA	1.53	4	4	5	6
4	HIMACHAL PRADESH	1.43	6	6	3	3
5	MADHYA PRADESH	1.41	3	5	6	7
6	GUJARAT	1.41	7	7	7	5
7	RAJASTHAN	1.38	5	3	4	4
8	ANDHRA PRADESH	1.05	8	8	9	9
9	MAHARASHTRA	1.01	9	9	8	8
10	HARYANA	0.85	11	11	13	10
11	CHHATTISGARH	0.80	10	10	10	NA
12	PUNJAB	0.54	13	12	11	12
13	ORISSA	0.52	12	13	15	11
14	ASSAM	0.44	16	18	18	16
15	JAMMU & KASHMIR	0.44	17	17	12	13
16	WEST BENGAL	0.40	14	14	14	14
17	UTTARAKHAND	0.35	15	15	16	NA
18	JHARKHAND	0.35	18	16	20	NA
19	BIHAR	0.30	20	19	19	17
20	UTTAR PRADESH	0.30	19	20	17	15

SMALL STATES

1	PUDUCHERRY	4.94	1	1	1	NA
2	SIKKIM	1.86	4	3	3	NA
3	NAGALAND	1.57	6	8	9	NA
4	MIZORAM	1.43	2	2	2	NA
5	DELHI	1.40	3	5	4	1
6	GOA	0.81	5	4	5	2
7	TRIPURA	0.54	8	7	6	NA
8	ARUNACHAL PRADESH	0.26	7	6	8	NA
9	MANIPUR	0.08	9	9	7	NA
10	MEGHALAYA	0.08	10	10	10	NA

UNION TERRITORIES

1	CHANDIGARH	2.04	1	2	2	NA
2	ANDAMAN & NICOBAR ISLANDS	1.43	2	3	3	NA
3	LAKSHADWEEP	0.80	3	1	1	NA
4	DAMAN & DIU	0.67	4	4	5	NA
5	DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI	0.61	5	5	4	NA

Karnataka is the FASTEST MOVER

Fastest Mover is the state where the rate of improvement on overall performance between 2003 and 2007 was greater than the rate of improvement between 1991 and 2003

METHODOLOGY

How they did it

Economists Bibek Debroy and Laveesh Bhandari explain the basics of the fifth annual India Today states study

1 Performance not Perception:

There are two ways to rate states. One is survey-based ratings that use people's opinion on different aspects of life in a state. This serves a limited purpose of gauging perception. People barely know the nitty gritty of the city they live in, much less of the rest of India. The other way is to use objective data. The INDIA TODAY State of the States study opts for this method and relies on data from Central sources.

2 Performance on What: The next step is to identify the criteria on which the states are to be compared. The eight heads selected for our analysis are: budget and prosperity, agriculture, consumer markets, primary education, primary health, law & order, infrastructure and investment environment. Each of these includes six-eight key variables that track the performance of states. These range from percentage of population above poverty line to inflation, from area under cash

crops to loans extended to farmers. The INDIA TODAY ranking is not just a human development ranking. Neither is the focus on investment attractiveness of states. The rankings study the best states to live in.

3 Small vs Big: There might be doubts if it is fair to compare states of different sizes. That is why the study classifies the 30 states into two groups—big and small. Also, absolute figures cannot be compared across states. Figures for every variable used in the study were normalised by dividing by population or area or a relevant denominator.

4 Score vs Rank: While ranks are more eye-catching, one should not read too much into them. It is index values that are crucial. Two states with little difference in index values can have very different ranks. Ranks aren't a good indicator of performance over the years either. A state's performance in 2006 may be better than in 2004, but its rank may be unchanged because other states have

per cent. Only three small states—Mizoram, Sikkim and Goa—score over 50 per cent while 20 states (big and small) don't even get the minimum 35 per cent to pass. Worse, on most parameters the median score is barely 2 out of 10 while the minimum scores in eight of nine categories are less than 10 per cent. The scores show the distance that is left to be travelled and what is really holding up growth. It also shows that the debate over reforms is being conducted in the wrong time zones. It is not that India lacks resources, but they are being squandered in a system that guarantees employment but not delivery of services. Worse, there is no system to ensure that big tag outlays and expenditure on social and phys-